Over 2.5 goals: V4 report

Thu 05 Nov 2026 to Fri 06 Nov 2026 (english). All times UK.

Executive summary

4 fixtures analysed: High 0, Medium 1, Weak 1, rejected 2. Selected fixtures with both attacks scoring 2+ in 3 of 5 or better: 0.

Selection engine: the validated model (V4 lock; V4.1 changes in config/model_config.json). Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-02 (1707 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 72 of 104, Medium 131 of 214, trump card 3 of 3, rejected 771 of 1386. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture. Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ counts are shown on every card as supporting evidence; both attacks at 3 of 5+ adds about three points inside the bands and is highlighted, not required.

Selected fixtures ranked by model score (up to 20)

#	Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	Home sc2+ / let2+	Away sc2+ / let2+	Both 3/5+	BTTS	Confidence	Division	Main risk (Over 2.5 = Yes for every row)
1	Fri 06 Nov 19:30	FA Cup	Bristol Rovers v Cambridge United	0/5 · 3/5	3/5 · 3/5		NO (Med)	Medium	warm	Bristol Rovers let in 2+ in 3 of 5 but scored 2+ only 0 of 5: leaky, not scoring
2	Fri 06 Nov 19:45	FA Cup	Oxford City v Leicester	2/5 · 1/5	4/5 · 2/5		NO (Med)	Weak	warm	Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

Grouped shortlist (date, competition, confidence, model score)

Fri 06 Nov · FA Cup

Medium	Bristol Rovers v Cambridge United 19:30	H scored 2+ 0/5 · H let in 2+ 3/5 · A scored 2+ 3/5 · A let in 2+ 3/5	BTTS NO (Medium)
Weak	Oxford City v Leicester 19:45	H scored 2+ 2/5 · H let in 2+ 1/5 · A scored 2+ 4/5 · A let in 2+ 2/5	BTTS NO (Medium)

Fixture cards

FA Cup

Bristol Rovers v Cambridge United

FA Cup · Fri 06 Nov 19:30 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence MEDIUM

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 9 of 20

Division: warm, 207 of 326 games had 3+

BRISTOL ROVERS home

oldest → newest

scores: 1-3, 0-1, 1-2, 0-0, 1-3

SCORED 2+		**0/5**
LET IN 2+		**3/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		3/5
At home, 3+		2/5

CAMBRIDGE UNITED away

oldest → newest

scores: 2-1, 2-2, 2-3, 1-1, 0-3

SCORED 2+		**3/5**
LET IN 2+		**3/5**
Game had 3+		4/5
Both scored		4/5
Away, 3+		3/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Bristol Rovers scored 2+: 0/5

Cambridge United let in 2+: 3/5

Route: Weak

Bristol Rovers: clean sheets 1/5, failed to score 2/5, both scored 3/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Cambridge United scored 2+: 3/5

Bristol Rovers let in 2+: 3/5

Route: Strong

Cambridge United: clean sheets 0/5, failed to score 1/5, both scored 4/5

Why: Bristol Rovers 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Cambridge United 4 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Bristol Rovers) and 4 of 5 (Cambridge United). Venue: Bristol Rovers 2 of 5 home games with 3+, Cambridge United 3 of 5 away.

Risk: Bristol Rovers let in 2+ in 3 of 5 but scored 2+ only 0 of 5: leaky, not scoring

Oxford City v Leicester

FA Cup · Fri 06 Nov 19:45 UK

OVER 2.5 YES · confidence WEAK

BTTS lean YES (model Medium) · drivers 9 of 20

Division: warm, 207 of 326 games had 3+

OXFORD CITY home

oldest → newest

scores: 1-1, 3-0, 1-1, 3-0, 1-3

SCORED 2+		**2/5**
LET IN 2+		**1/5**
Game had 3+		3/5
Both scored		3/5
At home, 3+		4/5

LEICESTER away

oldest → newest

scores: 2-1, 4-0, 1-2, 3-0, 2-2

SCORED 2+		**4/5**
LET IN 2+		**2/5**
Game had 3+		5/5
Both scored		3/5
Away, 3+		3/5

HOME ATTACK → AWAY DEFENCE

Oxford City scored 2+: 2/5

Leicester let in 2+: 2/5

Route: Some support

Oxford City: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 3/5

AWAY ATTACK → HOME DEFENCE

Leicester scored 2+: 4/5

Oxford City let in 2+: 1/5

Route: Weak

Leicester: clean sheets 2/5, failed to score 0/5, both scored 3/5

Why: Oxford City 3 of 5 games with 3+ and Leicester 5 of 5; both scored in 3 of 5 (Oxford City) and 3 of 5 (Leicester). Venue: Oxford City 4 of 5 home games with 3+, Leicester 3 of 5 away.

Risk: Home side kept 2/5 clean sheets

Rejected fixtures, with the model's reason

Kick-off (UK)	Competition	Fixture	H sc2+	H let2+	A sc2+	A let2+	Model	Reason
Fri 06 Nov 20:00	Premier League	Everton v Coventry	1/5	3/5	2/5	1/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 1/5 and 2/5
Fri 06 Nov 20:00	Championship	Derby v Bolton	0/5	3/5	2/5	2/5	rejected	model score below the selection line; attacks 0/5 and 2/5

Data coverage and limitations

• Fixtures analysed: 4. Every count is taken from the stored final score of each match (fixture ID, teams, score); the five scorelines are printed on each card.

• Form sample: each side's last five completed league games this season, cup ties excluded; venue rows use the last five league games at that venue, sample size shown when fewer.

• Not covered by API Sports for 2026-27: Northern Premier, Isthmian and Southern League Division One. 'England V2' is not an API Sports competition and was not included.

• Scored first / conceded after leading: needs match event timelines, not pulled (one call per match, no history). Not shown. First-half goals: available from half-time scores, not yet on the card.

• Injuries and suspensions: the API returned lists for a minority of fixtures this week; nothing is inferred where it returned none. Squad rotation in cup ties is not assessed.

• Opposition strength: each side's opponents' scoring versus the division is held in the analysis file (oq columns) but is not part of the alignment score.

• Competitions in scope with no fixtures in the window: League One, League Two, National League, National League North, National League South, EFL Cup.

Methodology (V4 lock)

• Selection: gradient-boosted model on each side's last-5 league counts (goals, 3+, 2+ scored, 2+ conceded, clean sheets, failed to score, BTTS), last-3 venue counts and the division's 3+ share. Trained on 2023-24 and 2024-25, validated on 2025-26; cut points from validation deciles. High = top decile; Medium = next two; Weak = bottom quarter of Medium; rejected below.

• Benchmark, season 2026-27 to 2026-11-02 (1707 finished fixtures, Rob's 14 leagues, clean out of sample): 3+ goals in High 72 of 104, Medium 131 of 214, trump card 3 of 3, rejected 771 of 1386. Band counts, not the chance of any one fixture.

• Cup competitions (European and domestic cups), measured separately, season 2026-27 (1234 finished ties): 3+ goals in High 25 of 39, Medium 89 of 146, trump card 2 of 2, rejected 615 of 1047. Cup ties are outside the 14-league benchmark; treat cup selections with that in mind.

• Scored 2+ and Let in 2+ are shown for both sides as evidence. Both attacks 3 of 5+ is highlighted (Selected with it 66%, High 71%) but never required: High fixtures failing a 2-of-5 attacking rule hit 73% on 222 fixtures.

• BTTS (V4.1): YES when the BTTS model is in its High band or the fixture is a trump card; lean YES for the Medium band; no lean for the Low band. BTTS model bands, same fixtures: High 103 of 165, Medium 756 of 1353, Low 116 of 189 had both teams score. A lean, not a pick, and never a veto on Over 2.5.

• V2 and V3 alignment scores were tested (62 to 66% at comparable sizes) and are not used for selection. Full tables in docs/backtest_baseline.md.

• No averages anywhere. Nothing inferred for missing data. Every count comes from stored final scores; the five scorelines are printed on each card.